SCAD
The University for Creative Careers

ANIM 223 Historical Adventures in Cinematic Animation

Section: 01 CRN: 11769

MONTGO 309

Tuesday / Thursday 8:00 AM - 10:30 AM

SCAD mission

SCAD prepares talented students for creative professions through engaged teaching and learning in a positively oriented university environment.

SCAD vision

SCAD will be globally recognized as the preeminent source of knowledge in the disciplines we teach.

SCAD values

Be Strategic. Research and measure to guide work and document results.

Be Innovative. Generate new ideas and relevant solutions.

Be Positive. Approach all endeavors with enthusiasm.

Be Collaborative. Embrace and act upon our collective genius.

Be Transformative. Create life-changing experiences.

Be Compassionate. Treat everyone with kindness and care.

Instructor Information

Professor: John McIntyre
Email: jjmcinty@scad.edu
Phone: N/A
Office Location
Montgomery Hall cubicle 437
Office Hours: Fridays from 9am to 11 am

Course Description

From the first cartoons to blockbuster films, students focus on the history and aesthetics of animation with references to related arts. In this course, students explore a wide range of commercial and experimental works produced throughout the world, such as live-action cinema, puppetry and comics. Prerequisite(s): ANIM 190.

Student Learning Outcomes

1. Students will identify and discuss a wide range of historically significant animation.
2. Students will analyze the aesthetic styles and techniques employed by significant animators.
3. Students will contextualize films based on global, political, social and aesthetic perspectives.
4. Students will compare and contrast animation and live-action filmmaking techniques and styles.
5. Students will articulate how animation has evolved throughout its history.

Class Meeting Dates

1. Tuesday, September 15, 2026
2. Thursday, September 17, 2026
3. Tuesday, September 22, 2026
4. Thursday, September 24, 2026
5. Tuesday, September 29, 2026
6. Thursday, October 1, 2026
7. Tuesday, October 6, 2026
8. Thursday, October 8, 2026
9. Tuesday, October 13, 2026
10. Thursday, October 15, 2026
11. Tuesday, October 20, 2026
12. Thursday, October 22, 2026

13. Tuesday, October 27, 2026
14. Thursday, October 29, 2026
15. Tuesday, November 3, 2026
16. Thursday, November 5, 2026
17. Tuesday, November 10, 2026
18. Thursday, November 12, 2026
19. Tuesday, November 17, 2026
20. Thursday, November 19, 2026

Pre-quarter Assignment

Description
Acquire the textbook & prepare for Class One • Students will need to have a copy of the textbook by the beginning of the quarter in order to keep up with the reading assignments which correspond to the class lectures. The textbook is A New History of Animation by Maureen Furniss • **Students will introduce themselves during the first class.** Think about and be ready to discuss this topic: What animated shows or films inspired your interest in animation? • I'd like a volunteer to set up a Discord channel for this class. Contact me via email if you can do this. Once the Discord is set up, an invitation will be sent via email. Everyone, please go there and introduce yourselves when you receive the invitation. • Review and familiarize yourself with SCAD's Blackboard area for this course, including: Announcements, Course Supplements, and Grades. Assignments, syllabus, and support material will be posted there.

Schedule of Classes

Class	Date	Meeting Information
1		**Classroom Activity: Student Introductions** • Students will introduce themselves and share what shows or films inspired them to choose animation as their vocation. • Introduction to course and syllabus. **UNIT 1: EARLY ANIMATION** **Lecture: The Beginning** • Discussion of the origins of motion study before the invention of film, and the earliest forms of optical technology used to create the appearance of motion. • Discussion of how film first came into use to create animation and how it was used to reflect the world at the turn of the 20th century. • Screening examples of the earliest forms of animation by the pioneers of the art form. **Launch Assignment 1: Unit 1 Paper** • Ongoing writing assignment summarizing textbook chapter readings. • Detailed instructions will be provided on Blackboard. **Reading: A New History of Animation - Chapters 1 &2**

Class	Date	Meeting Information
2		**Lecture: Innovation & Experimentation in the early Silent Era** • Animation grew from novelty and moving comics to more believable scenes that were influenced by contemporary society, from independent artists to the studio system, from obscurity to popular entertainment. • Important early contributions are screened from French animator Emile Cohl, Russian animator Ladislas Starevich, and German pioneering feature film animator, Lotte Reiniger. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Professor will engage the students in a class discussion about the innovations that took place during the earliest examples of film animation. Contemporary technologic and cultural advances will be the focus.
3		**Lecture: Growth of the Animation Industry in the 1920's** • The competition among newly established studios for market share helped create demand for animation in a developing niche of the film business. These films were primarily short subjects. • The two most famous studios that drove the evolution of animation from the Silent Era into the thirties were the Disney and Fleischer studios. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Professor will engage the students in a class discussion about how competition drove the studios to improve their craft. **Reading: A New History of Animation - Chapters 3 & 4**

Class	Date	Meeting Information
4		**Lecture: Animation Matures as an Art Form** • An increasing number of independent artists and studios to push the art of animation to another level into the early 1930s. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Professor will engage the students in a class discussion about how mastery of their craft allows artists to expand their views on their chosen form of expression in the arts. • **Reading: A New History of Animation - Chapter 5 & 6**
5		**UNIT 2: The Influence of Modernism** **Lecture: First Features and Better Storytelling with Improved Believability** • After the first world war European art movements influence the works of animation artists, especially in Germany. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Professor will lead students in a discussion about how European art movements in the first decade after WWI influenced future generations of animation filmmakers.

Class	Date	Meeting Information
6		**Lecture: Warner Bros.** • Termite Terrace "terrorized" movie audiences, and how its influences are still felt in the animation industry today. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Students will discuss the examples provided in class. • **Reading: A New History of Animation, Chapters 7 & 8**
7		**Lecture: MGM and other Hollywood studios** • Animated short comedies of the 30s and 40s became the staple of other studios besides Warner Bros., and the audiences couldn't get enough. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Students will discuss the examples provided in class.
8		**Lecture: Wartime Animation** • The worldwide emergence of animated filmmaking was used to entertain, inform, and persuade audiences during World War II. Examples of wartime propaganda from Japan, Germany, Russia, Italy, and the US will be screened and discussed. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Students will discuss the impact animation had on global culture during the second World War. • **Reading: A New History of Animation, Chapter 9**

Class	Date	Meeting Information
9		**UNIT 3: MODERN ERA** **Lecture: Post-War and Midcentury Developments** • The growth of animation across the globe especially in Eastern Europe and Asia. • How the American design aesthetic evolved after World War II, especially in the 50's, peaking with Sleeping Beauty in 1959. • **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** ◦ Professor will lead the students to discuss the efforts animation artists made to explore new styles and techniques in animation. **Reading: A New History of Animation, Chapters 10 & 11**

Class	Date	Meeting Information
10		**DUE: Assignment 1 - Submit remaining textbook summaries of chapters 1 thru 11.** **DUE: Assignment 2 - Midterm Test - Multiple choice and short answer - In Class Only** • Multiple choice and short answer test will be taken in class only today Class 10 **Lecture: Rise of Stop Motion** • The early history of stop-motion animation techniques. Works from Eastern Europe and Japan will be explored. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Students will discuss their favorite examples of the stop-motion animation style. **Launch Assignment 3: Unit 3 Paper** • Due by the beginning of Class 19 • Ongoing writing assignment summarizing textbook chapter readings. • Detailed instructions will be provided on Blackboard.

Class	Date	Meeting Information
11		**Lecture: Animation Moves to the Small Screen as Live Action Did** • Animation made the transition to television in the same way that live-action entertainment did. • Early TV animation was targeted toward children because they were the easiest audience to please within the small budgets for TV as well as other factors. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Students will talk about the animated TV shows that set the trends for the programs they watched on their small screens as kids. **Reading: A New History of Animation, Chapters 12 & 13**
12		**Lecture: Experimentation and Computers** • The art of animation continued to evolve from the postwar era experimentation with aesthetics into new ways to exploit the use of art in storytelling and then using computers to create animation art. • The use of computers as animation tools also had an effect on the development of stories and characters.

Class	Date	Meeting Information
13		**UNIT 4: TRANSITION** Lecture: The Beginning of a Decline in Animated Theatrical Features • Walt Disney focuses on company's expansion. His death in 1966 and changes within the industry. • Smaller budgets and audiences, animation in live-action films, etc. • Live-action film trends affected animated entertainment **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Professor will lead a class discussion about the reasons for the downturn in the popularity of new animated films in the late 60's through the mid 80's. **Reading: A New History of Animation, Chapters 14 & 15**

Class	Date	Meeting Information
14		**Launch Assignment 4 Team Presentation Project - All are Due by start of Class 19** • Class will be divided into teams with 4 or 5 members • Student teams will choose a project to create from a list of Animation history topics. • Teams will divide their projects into equal assignments as they research and create a slide deck presentation with informative text, visual material, and brief film clips related to the realm of animation history they have chosen. • This presentation will be worth 25% of the course grade. Each students will be graded individually based on their contribution to the project, their presentation, and their overall participation in the class. • Detailed instructions will be provided on Blackboard. The Professor will provide an overview of presentation expectations and topic choices for presentation. • Over the weekend teams will establish a team discord, discuss and determine their 1st and 2nd choice of topic. **Lecture: Bluth, Bakshi, & Williams** • The new visionaries who struggled to carry Walt Disney's storytelling torch successfully for a sustained amount of time. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Professor will lead the students to share and discuss their reactions to the animation auteurs in the post-Walt Disney era.

Class	Date	Meeting Information
15		**Lecture: Animation Festivals & Short Films** • Animated short films experienced a rebirth in popularity when animation festivals screened them in movie theaters that targeted both young adult audience and older adults. • Short films from The Netherlands, France, and Czechoslovakia will be screened. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Professor will lead students to discuss their knowledge and appreciation of well-known animated short films and the festivals that introduce them to the public. **Reading: A New History of Animation, Chapters 16, 17, & 18**
16		**Lecture: Animation in Canada** • Canada has built a strong international reputation for animation, known for its innovative storytelling, high production values, and diverse styles and experimental shorts by the National Film Board. Films of pioneering Scottish-Canadian animator Norman McLaren and others will be screened. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Students will discuss the intersection of live action and animation as demonstrated in the films screened today.

Class	Date	Meeting Information
17		**UNIT 5: SECOND GOLDEN AGE** **Lecture: The Disney Renaissance** • Audiences were "drawn" back to the movie theaters by the improved entertainment value of Disney films, and how that rebirth in popularity and financial success led to the creation of new studios competing for animation talent and their share of the market. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Students will discuss how they were personally affected by the new Disney classics and how those films impacted the global animation industry. **Presentation Team Discussions - Assignment 4:** • Presentation teams will be given time to discuss their progress and clarify any inconsistencies or redundancies in their presentation. • Teams will be given a demo on best presentation practices including, eye contact with the audience, projecting the voice with enthusiasm, designing an engaging and informative slide deck. **Reading: A New History of Animation, Chapters 19 & 20**

Class	Date	Meeting Information
18		**Lecture: Emergence of Electronic Games & 3D Experimentation** • The pioneers of 3D character animation didn't rely solely upon the new technology to attract audiences to their films. Many in the industry mistakenly credited the new animation style for PIXAR's unprecedented success. **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Professor will lead students to discuss the impact PIXAR animation has had on their view of animation from the viewpoint of being a fan and being a student of animation storytelling. • **Reading: A New History of Animation, Chapters 21 & 22**
19		**DUE: Assignment 3 - Submit remaining textbook summaries of chapters 12 thru 24.** **DUE: Assignment 4 - Team Presentation Project** • The final submission of all slides is by the end of Class 19 **Lecture: Japanese Animation** • The origins and global popularity of Anime and Manga. • How did Japanese culture gradually come to dominate the attention of animation fans beginning in the 80's? **Classroom Activity: Discuss the Contents of the Lecture** • Students will be lead in a discussion to share their impressions of Anime and discuss any influence it has on their appreciation of animation as art and a storytelling technique.

Class	Date	Meeting Information
20		**DUE: Assignment 5 - Final Test - Multiple choice and short answer - In Class Only** **Lecture: Technology and Entertainment** • The evolution of animation tools, styles, and techniques has provided many choices to artists and filmmakers and have improved animators' ability to enhance believability. • International Animation Festivals in France, Ottawa, Zagreb and Hiroshima further expand the global interest in animation. **Classroom Activity: Have Improvements in Animation Techniques Made Animated Films More Entertaining?** • Professor will lead a final class discussion about the evolution of animation art and technology over the last 140 years.

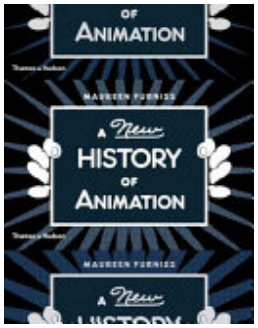
Grading Opportunities

#	Due Date	Assignment	Weight
1	10/15/26	Assignment 1 - Written summaries of textbook chapters 1 thru 11	15%
2	10/15/26	Midterm Test	20%
3	11/17/26	Assignment 3 -Written summaries of textbook chapters 12 thru 24	20%
4	11/17/26	Assignment 4 - Team Presentation Project	25%
5	11/19/26	Final Test	20%

Grading Standards

Letter Grade	Quality	Range	Undergraduate Quality Points	Graduate Quality Points
A	Excellent	90 - 100%	4	4
B	Good	80 - 89%	3	3
C	Satisfactory	70 - 79%	2	2
D	Poor	60 - 69%	1	0
F	Failing	0 - 59%	0	0

Required Readings



A New History of Animation
ISBN: 9780500292099
Authors: Maureen Furniss
Publication Date: 2016-01-01
Edition: Illustrated

Required Materials

Materials for Taking Notes

- Pencil and/or pen on paper is the preferred method of note-taking for this class. Students may write their notes using other techniques, but the best way to remember what you write is by hand. Therefore, the next best method would be using a stylus on an electronic screen.

SCAD Bookstore

The SCAD bookstore carries textbooks, art supplies, and other materials to meet students' academic needs. Please visit the website linked below and search for this course to view costs of associated texts and materials.

Savannah – Ex Libris

228 Martin Luther King Jr. Blvd

Phone: 912.525.7550

https://www.bkstr.com/savannahstore/home

Atlanta – Ex Libris

1470 Spring St, SW

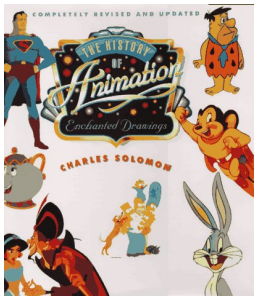
Phone: 404.253.6088

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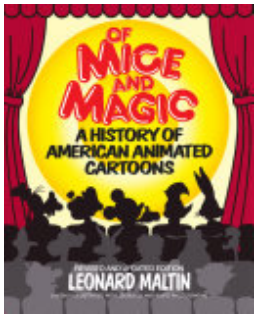
SCADnow

https://www.bkstr.com/savannahstore/home

Recommended Readings



Title of Book or Reading List: Enchanted Drawings
ISBN: 9780517118597
Authors: Charles Solomon
Publisher: Randon House Value Publishing
Publication Date: October 16, 1994



Title of Book or Reading List: Of Mice and Magic
ISBN: 978-0452259935
Authors: Leonard Maltin
Publisher: Plume
Publication Date: 12-1-1987
Edition: Revised & Updated

Study (Field) Trips

Study Trip	Date	Description
1	11/7/26	Jen Library Visit to view a selection of works from the Don Bluth Animation Production Collection from 10 am to 12 pm.

Extra Help Sessions

Extra Help Sessions	Date	Description
1	10/15/26	An extra help session will be available on Thursday week 5, from 2 pm tho 4 pm in room 309.

Extended Learning Opportunities

Extended learning opportunities are designed to enrich and expand students' course-based learning experiences. These university-wide extended learning opportunities (i.e., SCADamp workshops, SCADextra workshops, events and exhibitions, guided studio work, and virtual engagements) are offered both on-ground and virtually and allow students to further explore their discipline, discover new information, and deepen academic engagement.

Use the links below to view the schedule of upcoming events.

https://myevents.scad.edu/

https://app.scad.edu/workshops/

Information regarding extended learning opportunities specific to this course may also be communicated via Blackboard.

Suggested Extended Learning Opportunities

SCAD AnimationFest - Wednesday, Sept. 23 - Friday, Sept. 25

at the SCADshow Theater, 1470 Spring St. NW, Atlanta, GA

SCAD's signature event for all things digital media, SCAD AnimationFest returns to SCAD Atlanta's SCADshow theater this September to showcase the latest trends, groundbreaking work, and top animated content across film, television, social media, and more. Join industry guests at this three-day festival and learn new applications and techniques in entertainment, make contacts with global studios and companies, and view films and TV shows from studios and networks like Netflix, Disney, CBS, FX, Fox, and Hulu as well as from standout SCAD student animators.

SCAD Savannah Film Festival - Saturday, Oct. 24 – Saturday, Oct. 31

The largest university-run film festival in the world. Set against the fall backdrop of the South's most beautiful city, the SCAD Savannah Film Festival welcomes more than 60,000 guests for an eight-day celebration of cinematic excellence and creativity. Each October, SCAD transforms historic Savannah into a film lover's paradise, presenting competition film screenings, gala premieres, special screenings, workshops, and panels with lauded industry guests, award-winning professionals, and emerging student filmmakers.

Digital Presence: Portfolios for Animators, VFX Artists, and More! - Friday, Oct. 16 — 3pm - 4pm

Deloitte Foundry, 3rd Floor Event Space

Explore the key elements of building a strong digital presence through your professional portfolio. Digital portfolios are essential for a wide range of roles, including animators, generalists, concept artists, and more!

Led by SCAD career adviser Amba Moore (B.F.A., animation, 2020), a Golden Globe–winning animator on Guillermo del Toro's Pinocchio, this

Suggested Extended Learning Opportunities
session will highlight professional portfolio examples and provide guidance on showcasing your process, selecting impactful content, and incorporating bonus materials that help your application stand out. **Extra Learning Opportunities:** SCADextra Find a workshop that works for you! https://scad-content.blackboard.com/bbcswebdav/institution/Institution%20Page%20Assets/SCADextra/eventsworkshops.html

Additional Course Information

You came here to learn about the history of animation as a worldwide art form and industry. This course will demonstrate how cultures have influenced animation and how animation has influenced culture.

Study these films like an animator – Observe movement, design, and storytelling choices in every film.

Listen for context – note how historical events, technology, and culture shaped the work.

Spot the connections – trace how earlier techniques and styles influenced later films.

Engage with the timeline – ask questions that link past innovations to today's animation.

Build your reference library – keep a curated list of films, scenes, and creators that inspire you.

Students with approved accommodations must email the professor to activate them. To use extra-time accommodations, the professor must be notified before the assignment's due date. Extended deadlines allow up to 48 hours past the original due date.

SCAD Libraries and Academic Resources

SCAD Libraries
Students at all SCAD locations can access SCAD Libraries' extensive collections, digital resources, and research assistance both in person and online. Explore SCAD Libraries here: Millennium Web Catalog (scad.edu).

SCADextra Coaching: Academic Resources
SCADextra Coaching is your primary source for academic resources and support for students at all SCAD locations. Our services are free of charge and can be found in the Blackboard Assist portal at https://scad.blackboard.com/ultra/integration/bbAssist.

University Policies

Academic Integrity

SCAD students are expected to uphold the highest standards of honesty and ethical conduct in all academic endeavors. This commitment to integrity not only ensures the authenticity and value of a SCAD education but also cultivates a culture of trust, respect, and innovation that is crucial in creative industries.

Under all circumstances, students must be honest in their dealings with faculty, administrative staff, and fellow students, and they must submit work that accurately reflects their level of accomplishment. Thus, students shall not engage in an activity that undermines academic integrity or facilitates academic dishonesty by others. This includes, but is not limited to, the following behaviors:

1. Cheating: Using unauthorized assistance, materials, or technology in any academic work.
2. Plagiarism: Using someone else's work, ideas, or words without proper attribution.
3. Fabrication: Falsifying data, information, or citations in academic work.
4. Multiple Submission: Submitting the same work for multiple courses without prior written approval.

5. Facilitation: Helping others commit academic dishonesty or failing to report known academic integrity violations.

If a faculty member suspects a student of academic dishonesty, the faculty member notifies the student of this concern. Once this notification has occurred, the student is prohibited from seeking to withdraw from the course pending the result of a possible investigation. If academic dishonesty is suspected, the faculty member must email all evidence and documentation to **academicdishonesty@scad.edu**.

If the allegation warrants investigation, an academic administrator is appointed to investigate the allegation. If the investigator finds that academic dishonesty has occurred, the student is informed in writing that they will receive an F in the course. The student has five business days from the date on the written notice to appeal the decision of the investigator. If no appeal is made, the student is assigned a grade of F in the course and the student forfeits the right to continue to attend the course in which the academic dishonesty occurred. Students wishing to appeal should do so by emailing **academicappeals@scad.edu**. An appeals committee then convenes to review the case. Findings are presented to academic services, who sends the student a final decision in writing within 30 days of the written appeal. A student found to be in violation of the academic integrity policy may not withdraw from the course(s) in question. Additional sanctions may also be imposed, including suspension or dismissal. A second finding of academic dishonesty may result in dismissal from SCAD.

Attendance and Personal Conduct:
Students are expected to actively engage in courses to achieve the required learning outcomes. Absences in excess of 20% of the course (e.g., five absences for a 10-week course that meets twice per week) result in the student receiving a failing grade, unless the student withdraws from the course in accordance with the withdrawal policy. Absences due to late registration are included in the overall absences permitted for the course.

For **on-ground** courses, students are expected to attend and participate in all scheduled class sessions. Tardiness, early departure, or other time away from class in excess of 15 minutes per class session is considered an absence for that class session.

Students enrolled in **SCADnow** courses are required to check the online course site regularly and academically engage in the daily work of the course. Students earn attendance in SCADnow online courses through active participation in live class sessions and/or asynchronously by participating in

academically related activities on a minimum of two separate days per unit/week.

To access the entire academic integrity policy and procedure, please visit SCAD / Compliance and policies / Attendance.

The student's appearance and conduct should be appropriate and should contribute to the academic and professional atmosphere of SCAD. The university reserves the right at its sole discretion to withdraw the privilege of enrollment from any student whose conduct is detrimental to the academic environment or to the well-being of other students, faculty or staff members, or to the university facilities.

Enrollment policies:
Students are responsible for assuring proper enrollment. See the SCAD catalog for information on add/drop, withdrawals, incompletes, and academic standing.

Midterm Conference(s):
Each student enrolled in the course will have a midterm conference scheduled outside of class time with the professor. Students are expected to keep this appointment.

Access and Accommodations:
Access and Accommodations through The Office of Disability Resources: SCAD is committed to providing an accessible and inclusive environment for all students. Students with established academic accommodations under the ADA from the Office of Disability Resources are encouraged to provide their letter of approved accommodations to faculty in classes in which they are enrolled as soon as possible, as only students who provide the letter are eligible to use their accommodations. Students who have not yet established services through The Office of Disability Resources and have a documented disability may require academic accommodations are encouraged to contact The Office of Disability Resources as soon as possible since timely notice is needed to coordinate accommodations. The Office of Disability Resources staff will evaluate each request with required documentation, recommend reasonable accommodations, and prepare a letter of approved accommodations for students to provide to faculty dated in the current quarter in which the request is being made. Students are required to renew their accommodations each quarter through the SCAD Accommodate portal to receive their updated accommodations. Students may contact The Office of Disability Resources at disability@scad.edu or 912-525-6233.

Course Evaluations:

Course evaluations offer students a dedicated opportunity to provide constructive feedback on each of their courses. Student feedback gathered through course evaluations is essential to continuously improving the SCAD academic experience. Evaluations are available to students each quarter during Weeks 8, 9, and 10 through MySCAD. For additional information, contact evaluations@scad.edu.

Student Surveys:

SCAD strongly encourages students to provide feedback on their university experience through institutional surveys. The SCAD Student Survey and the Ruffalo Noel Levitz Student Satisfaction Inventory are administered to students across locations each spring. The National Survey of Student Engagement is administered biennially in winter. Following survey administration, SCAD's institutional effectiveness department analyzes and reports results to various SCAD departments to inform data-driven enhancements. For additional information, contact surveys@scad.edu.